NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Brookline

Brookline, Massachusetts

59.1

out of 100

▲ Strength: **Schools**

▼ Weakness: **Housing**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Nestled in the heart of Brookline, Massachusetts, the neighborhood of Brookline is a solid choice for those seeking a vibrant and diverse community with a strong emphasis on education. With a master score of 59.1 out of 100, this neighborhood boasts top-notch schools, scoring an impressive 87.5, making it an ideal destination for families with children. The tree-lined streets, historic homes, and lush parks create a charming and picturesque backdrop, while the bustling commercial districts offer a variety of shopping, dining, and entertainment options.

Brookline's prime location and excellent transit score of 78.0 make it a commuter's paradise, with easy access to downtown Boston and other neighboring communities. This, coupled with a respectable score of 60.6 for Bluebikes, makes it an excellent choice for those who prefer a car-free lifestyle or enjoy the convenience of public transportation. However, with a housing score of just 25.8, potential residents should be prepared for a competitive market and higher housing costs. This trade-off is worth considering, especially for those who prioritize location and accessibility over housing affordability.

Despite its urban setting, Brookline maintains a strong sense of community and offers a safe and welcoming environment for its residents. With a safety score of 50.3, it's on par with many other urban neighborhoods, and the presence of excellent healthcare facilities (scoring 61.6) provides peace of mind. The neighborhood's unique blend of urban convenience and suburban charm makes it a great fit for families, professionals, and students alike. With its solid scores across various domains, Brookline, Massachusetts, stands out as a neighborhood that truly offers something for everyone.

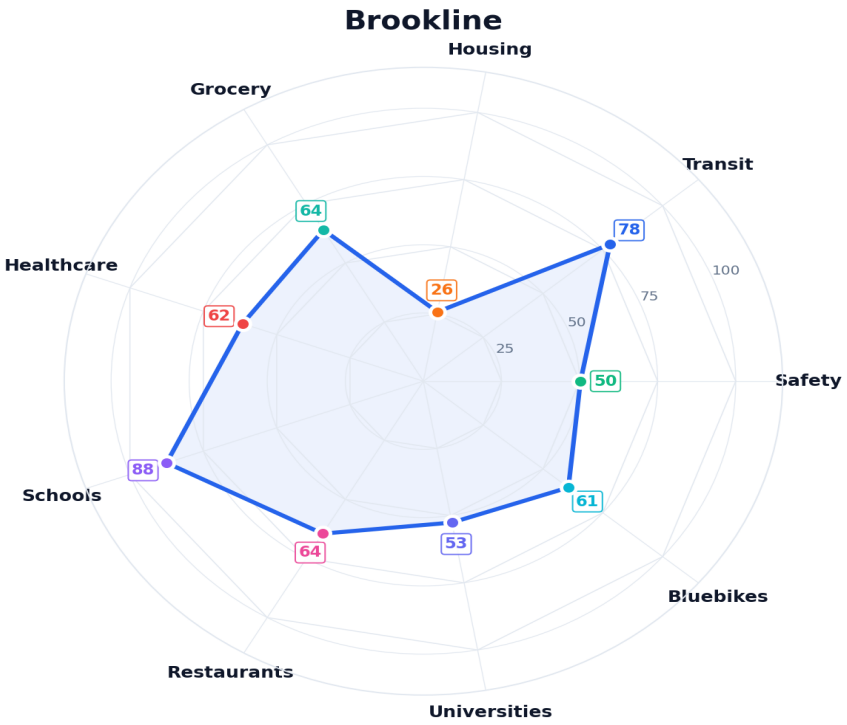
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	50.3	Good
Transit	78.0	Excellent
Housing	25.8	Premium
Grocery	64.0	Well Stocked
Healthcare	61.6	Good
Schools	87.5	Excellent
Restaurants	64.5	Good
Universities	52.6	Good

Bluebikes	60.6	Good

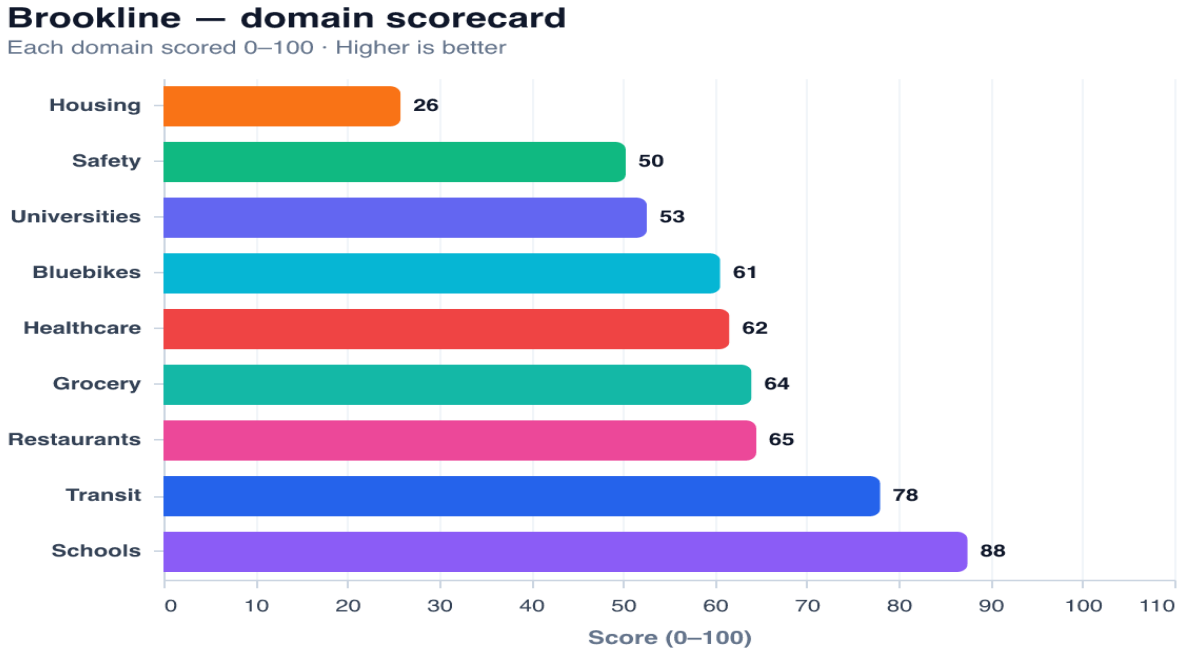
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

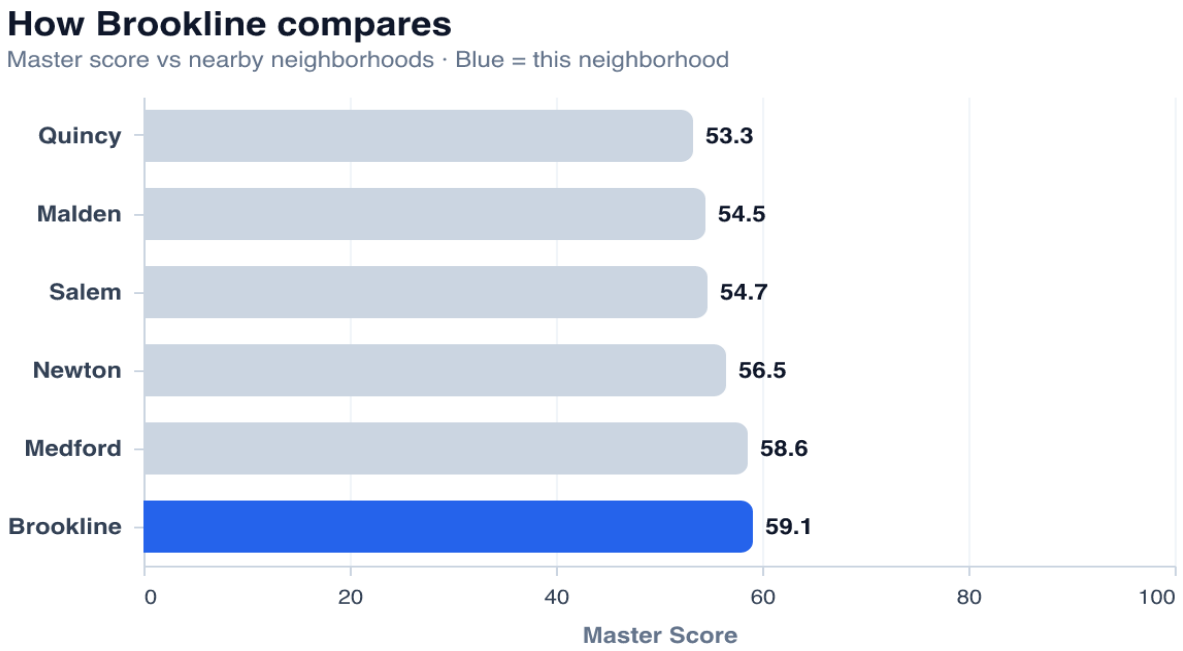
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher = stronger performance.

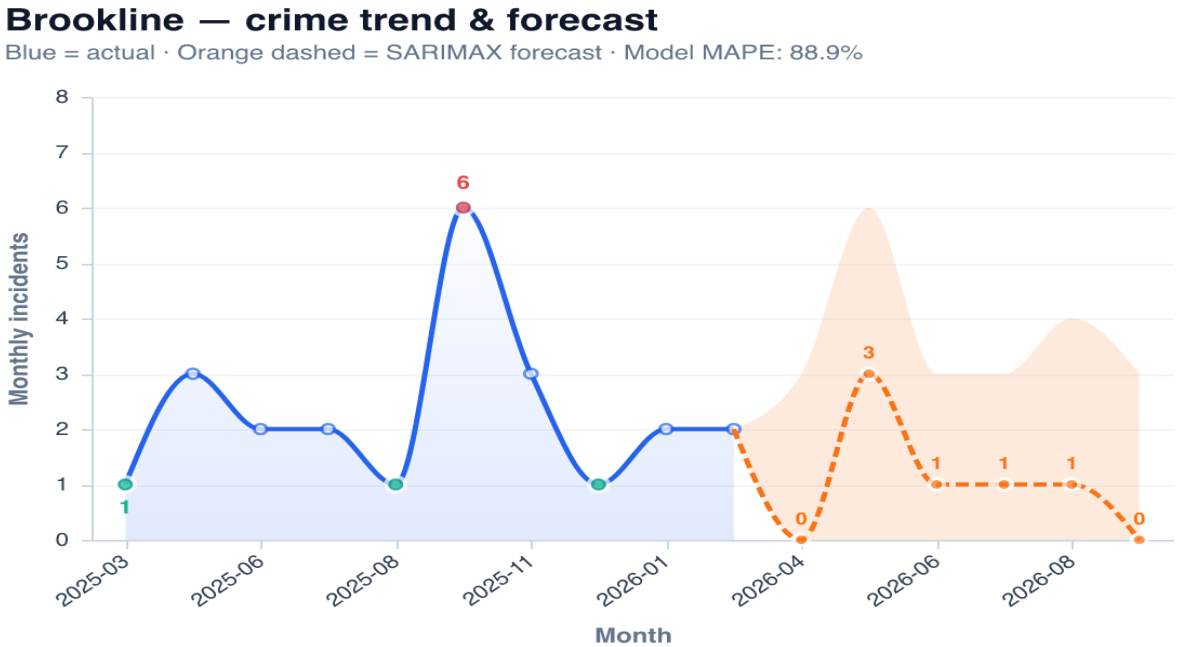
COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · vs 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast



Blue = actual · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast + CI band.

Trend: Stable · Model MAPE: 88.9% · Reliability: LOW

Brookline, a neighborhood in the Boston/Cambridge area, has maintained a stable crime trend over the past year, with an average of 2 monthly crimes. Remarkably, our ARIMA forecast predicts zero crimes by April 2026, although model accuracy can vary. Currently, there are no identified extreme crime hotspots within the neighborhood, making it a potentially safe place to reside.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

● Safety

In Brookline, Massachusetts, the safety score is rated as good at 50.3 out of 100, with a total of 1870 incidents reported from 2022 to 2024. The most prevalent crime type is larceny, falling under property crime, which makes up a significant 90.59% of all incidents. Violent crimes account for a relatively smaller proportion at 9.41%. Notably, there has been a 12.31% increase in crime year over year, indicating a rising trend that residents should be aware of.

● Transit

Brookline, a city in the Boston area, boasts an excellent transit score of 78.0 out of 100. It is served by two rapid transit routes, the Green Line C and D, with key destinations including Reservoir Station, Forest Hills Station, and Sullivan Square Station. The city has a total of 119 stops, with 16 rapid transit stops and 104 bus stops, making it a well-connected hub for public transportation. Notably, 86.6% of these stops are wheelchair accessible.

Restaurants

Brookline, Massachusetts, nestled within the town of Brookline, boasts a vibrant and diverse restaurant scene, offering a wide array of cuisines across six categories. With a density of 159.17 restaurants per square mile, diners are spoiled for choice. The overall quality is good, with 46.1% of the 1076 eateries rated as high quality, contributing to an average rating of 3.83 out of 5. The price mix leans towards mid-range options, with a healthy sprinkling of budget and upscale establishments. Notably, 87.5% of these restaurants offer delivery services.

Universities

Brookline, located in Brookline, Massachusetts, offers good access to higher education with a score of 52.6 out of 100. The town hosts two institutions, both providing bachelor's degrees and higher, with one also offering doctoral research programs. The Boston Graduate School of Psychoanalysis Inc., specializing in graduate medical programs, and Hellenic College-Holy Cross Greek Orthodox School of Theology, a liberal arts college, are the two institutions in the area. One of these institutions provides campus housing for students.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Brookline, Massachusetts, is a neighborhood that exudes a unique blend of urban sophistication and suburban tranquility. Its well-established transit infrastructure, primarily served by subway and commuter rail lines, is a testament to the neighborhood's development and growth. The proximity to downtown Boston, with approximately 57% of Boston's population and 79% of its employment within a 10-minute walk from a transit station, makes Brookline a highly desirable location for both residents and businesses. The neighborhood's predominantly white and upper-income demographic benefits significantly from this convenient access to public transportation.

However, the transit landscape in Brookline also reveals some disparities. While the neighborhood enjoys seamless connectivity to downtown Boston, other lower-income and minority neighborhoods often struggle with less convenient bus services. In some instances, buses are filled to capacity upon arriving in Boston's poorer, predominantly minority neighborhoods, or worse, bypass these communities completely. This unequal service has raised concerns, particularly among Latinx residents in Charlestown's public housing and persons with disabilities who face challenges with non-functioning elevators and escalators, and inadequate RIDE services for those unable to use subways or trains. The growing significance of ridesharing services in Boston's transportation system further highlights the need for more inclusive and equitable transit solutions.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. The neighborhood of Brookline in Brookline, Massachusetts, is most suitable for families. This is primarily due to the high score in the 'Schools' category (87.5), indicating excellent educational institutions, which is a key consideration for families. The 'Safety' score of 50.3, while not exceptionally high, is also a factor families might consider acceptable.

2. On the other hand, students and young professionals might want to look elsewhere. The 'Housing' score is quite low (25.8), suggesting that affordable housing options could be limited. Additionally, the 'Universities' score is relatively low (52.6), which might not be ideal for students looking for a vibrant academic environment or easy access to universities.